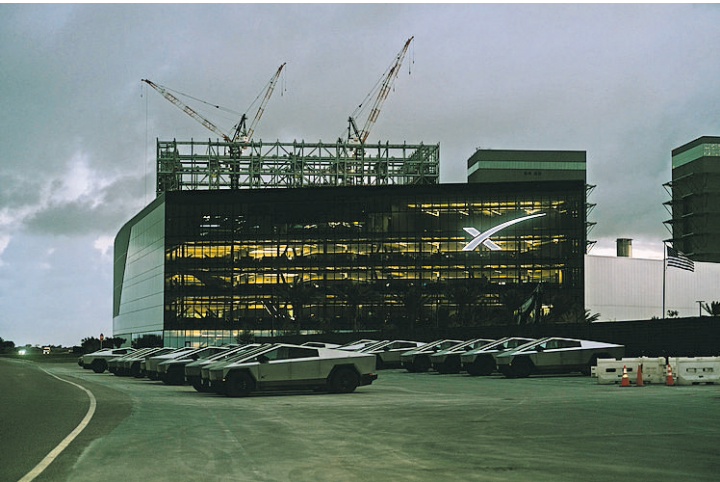




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While SpaceX's trading debut on Friday was tracked at the Nasdaq building in Times Square and on Wall Street, company executives celebrated in New York, right. Starbase, SpaceX's Texas home, top right, was a site of revelry by Elon Musk, family and workers.

SpaceX's I.P.O. Makes Musk The First Trillionaire on Earth

By RYAN MAC and LAUREN HIRSCH

LOS ANGELES — SpaceX, Elon Musk's rocket and artificial intelligence company, capped the biggest initial public offering ever by rising 20 percent in its trading debut on Friday, turning the world's richest man into the first trillionaire and setting the stage for fast-growing A.I. companies to reach the stock market in a once-in-a-lifetime bonanza.

SpaceX shares opened trading at \$150, up from their I.P.O. price of \$135, before closing the day at \$161.11. That valued the company at more than \$2 trillion, exceeding the market capitalizations of other titans of American industry, including Walmart and General Motors combined.

At that size, the offering dethroned Saudi Aramco, Saudi Ara-

Colossal A.I. Offerings Are Likely to Follow

bia's state-owned oil company, which was valued at \$1.7 trillion and raised more than \$29 billion when it went public in 2019. SpaceX raised \$75 billion from its offering, more than the combined amount amassed by every other U.S. I.P.O. over the past two years, according to Renaissance Capital, a research and advisory firm.

The pop in SpaceX's share price also catapulted Mr. Musk, 54, to trillionaire status. The entrepreneur, who not only leads SpaceX but also runs the electric car-maker Tesla and other businesses, has long been the planet's wealthiest person. But passing

Continued on Page A24

Super PACs Tied to A.I. Giants Muscle Into a N.Y. House Race

By NICHOLAS FANDOS

Super PACs tied to the nation's leading artificial intelligence giants have transformed the closing weeks of a race for a coveted New York City House seat by unleashing staggering amounts of money to shape its outcome and a national debate over regulating the industry.

Together, groups linked to the Silicon Valley rivals OpenAI and Anthropic have already spent more than \$12 million stuffing mailboxes and blanketing TV screens with costly broadcast ads — including during the Knicks N.B.A. finals games. Other groups with ties to industry players have chipped in another \$4 million, with more on the way.

With less than two weeks before the June 23 Democratic primary, the A.I.-related expenditures —

Millions Spent in Bid to Influence Regulation

alongside an unrelated \$10 million infusion by former Mayor Michael R. Bloomberg — could end up making the contest in Manhattan one of the most expensive in congressional history.

And all of it is most likely a preview of an even bigger battle to come in the midterms this fall, when groups tied to leading technology companies have pledged to spend hundreds of millions of dollars around elections that could determine whether Congress pursues new guardrails for the industry.

"It's a real test of whether corporate interests from California,

Continued on Page A15

In Chavez's Union, Women Often Worked in Fear

By SARAH HURTES and MANNY FERNANDEZ

After watching a documentary at school about farmworkers getting beaten on picket lines, Anita Romero Torres had one dream: to join Cesar Chavez and the United Farm Workers. In 1977, at age 17, she arrived at the union's La Paz headquarters in the California mountains. But within weeks, she began to grow fearful — not of agitators on the picket lines, but of the men she worked with.

In the department where she was assigned, her supervisor began calling her several times a day, reminding her that they would be spending a lot of time alone together in the fields. "Sometimes it'll be really late at night in very isolated places," she said he told her. "Nobody's going to know where we are."

The calls "seemed very strange and uncomfortable," she said. "He was basically telling me that he was going to take me out in a field somewhere and rape me."

When she reported the calls to Mr. Chavez, the response was, for her, a devastating lesson in institutional priorities. Mr. Chavez told her that the man was too important to the cause to be removed from his job. His solution was to transfer the man's wife into her department to keep an eye on him.

The harassment, she said, didn't stop there. A different male co-

Claims of Abuse Surface Beyond Rights Leader

worker groped her in the office. Another cornered her in a locked room and tried to push himself on her before she narrowly escaped. Three years after she started, Ms. Romero Torres quit.

"It became impossible to do what I came to do, what I love," she said. "What broke my heart about the U.F.W. is I felt that I left because of the way that men behaved there."

A New York Times investiga-

tion this year uncovered substantial evidence that Mr. Chavez, a key figure in America's civil rights history, had sexually abused young teenage girls and engaged in other sexual misconduct over a period of decades. The revelations led to a nationwide reckoning, with communities across the country canceling events, removing statues and re-examining art-work celebrating Mr. Chavez.

But the abuse did not begin or end with Mr. Chavez, new interviews and documents show. Many other women faced devastating sexual assault and harassment from men they worked with — in

Continued on Page A12



JOHN SOTOMAYOR/THE NEW YORK TIMES

Cesar Chavez and other top U.F.W. leaders faced accusations.

Prolific Artist Who Put People Back in Paintings

By HOLLAND COTTER

David Hockney, the English artist whose deftly designed and suavely colored paintings turned trans-Atlantic attention to figurative and narrative art beginning in the late 1950s and early 1960s after decades in which abstraction had dominated, died on Thursday at his home in London. He was 88.

His publicist, Erica Bolton, confirmed the death. No cause was provided.

A native of Yorkshire, Mr. Hockney lived for many years in Los Angeles, long enough to refer to himself as an "English Los Angeleno" and to create images that, for many viewers, captured the sun-soaked atmosphere of that city as surely as Joan Didion did in prose. And although his art was conservative in an era that also gave rise to Conceptualism, he was progressive in at least one way: He was one of the first widely popular artists of his time to make work with undisguised gay content and one of the few to take a public stand against the censoring of homosexual imagery.

His death came nine months after the close of a sprawling retrospective exhibition of his work at the Louis Vuitton Foundation in Paris. But even at that point, he

Continued on Page A18

DAVID HOCKNEY, 1937-2026



DAVID HOCKNEY; HUNTINGTON LIBRARY, ART MUSEUM, AND BOTANICAL GARDENS, SAN MARINO, CALIF. David Hockney's "Self-Portrait With Red Braces" (2003).

SPORTS B6-9

Brawls, Biting and Bliss

Decades of bottled-up hopes have created a frenzy that has brought out the worst in some Knicks fans. PAGE B6

'The Pearl' Copes With Pain

His body reminds Earl Monroe of his role in the 1973 championship. At 81, he is driven by a charter school. PAGE B8



NATIONAL A10-16, 24

Tumultuous Texas Race

A runoff in a Dallas suburb may show whether anti-Muslim sentiments, prominent in G.O.P. primaries this year, can win over more voters. PAGE A10

Watching Out for U.S. Enemies

Worries that America will be dangerously blind when a key surveillance power expires may be unfounded since spying can go on. PAGE A11

Sex Scandal for Federal Judge

A jurist in Georgia faced calls for impeachment after reports went public concerning her attempts to cover up her affair with a police officer. PAGE A16

INTERNATIONAL A4-9

Ukrainians Fly Drones for Fun

Soldiers take breaks from the battlefield by recharging with their families and friends at festival-like races held at places like theme parks. PAGE A4

A Region of Climate Extremes

Every season brings a new struggle to a district in Pakistan prone to droughts, sandstorms and flooding. PAGE A7

BUSINESS B1-5

Betting on the World Cup

At a time of sluggish growth, gambling sites like FanDuel are counting on the tournament for a boost. PAGE B1

TRAVEL C7-8

Revolutionary Journeys

In South Carolina, Charleston's charm hides a bloody history in a crucial role in the fight for independence. PAGE C7

The Isle of Skye, Scotland

Summer can get crowded, but with sunsets as late as 10 p.m., it can be an ideal time to visit. PAGE C8



ARTS C1-6

'Romeo & Juliet' in the Park

At the Delacorte Theater, a familiar tragedy features division by language and by a wall. PAGE C1

Crisis at Boston Symphony

The orchestra has acknowledged mishandling the termination of its music director's contract. PAGE C1

OPINION A22-23

Michelle Goldberg

PAGE A22

